response, Makki penned a three-part series entitled ‘Fidayee Activities in Sharia’ to dispel the ‘common misconception that fidayee missions are suicide missions.’[84] Throughout the series, he attempted to ground these missions in Islamic history. Makki argued that:

> A fidayee activity means attacking the enemy risking one’s life, without taking necessary precautions, pouncing upon the enemy in the face of sure death, completing one’s mission at every cost; If one embraces martyrdom in this course one feels it a divine blessing and if returns alive successfully one is jubilant over Allaah’s bounty.[85]

The crucial distinction is that ‘no fidayee ever killed himself’ and if he is going to die then ‘the fidayee would like to be killed by an infidel or unbeliever.’[86] In other words there are high prospects of martyrdom, but the fidayee tries to survive as long as possible during the attack. On a number of occasions fidayeen came back alive following a mission. The ultimate intention was typically martyrdom, however, and those who undertook fidayeen attacks often returned to combat repeatedly until they achieved it.[87] When the fidayee died it was because he fought to the death rather than dying by his own hand.

These direct and daring attacks against Indian forces cemented Lashkar’s reputation as the premier militant group fighting in Kashmir and earned it the—at times grudging—respect of the local populace as well as other insurgents and the Indian military. Fidayeen attacks proved so effective that Jaish-e-Mohammad also adopted the tactic soon after it entered the Kashmir theater. Less doctrinally rigorous than Lashkar, JeM added a twist. It introduced suicide bombing to the Kashmir jihad. JeM was formed when Maulana Azhur, whose arrest along with several others triggered the wave of kidnappings in the mid-1990s, was freed following a HuM hijacking of Indian Airlines Flight 814 in 1999. He expressed his appreciation by promptly leaving to form his own outfit, taking many HuM cadres and resources with him. JeM quickly became one of the state’s favored proxies and several experts on Pakistani militancy have suggested the ISI sponsored JeM’s creation in order to check Lashkar’s growing power.[88] Not surprisingly, the two groups had an uneasy relationship from the outset, sometimes cooperating and sometimes competing in the Kashmir theater. Their combined activities helped to elevate the level of violence. Between mid-1999 and the end of 2002, at least fifty-five